

chamber in ten days and 18 hours.

Before making the liner, materials engineers built several other test parts, characterised the material and created a process for additive manufacturing with copper.

Disney's 3D printer uses fabric to create soft objects

A new type of 3D printer, created by Disney Research, allows layers of soft fabric to be used instead of plastic or metal. The printer works by laying down a sheet of fabric, felt, cotton or synthetic, and using a laser to cut the shape of the bottom-most layer.

The sheet is then treated with a heat-sensitive adhesive and another layer of fabric placed on top, which is then laser-cut again in the shape of the next layer, and so on. At the end, the fabric surrounding the object being built, layer by layer, can be removed, leaving behind the object itself.

Tesla introduces batteries to power homes

American electric carmaker, Tesla Motors, has launched batteries that can power homes and businesses in an attempt to expand beyond its



Powerwall batteries by Tesla

automobile business. The rechargeable lithium-ion battery unit would be built using the same batteries Tesla produces for its electric vehicles.

CEO Elon Musk has said that these batteries would store solar energy and serve as a backup system during blackouts. The system, called Powerwall, would allow users to get off a power grid or bring energy to remote areas that are not on a grid.

Dlodlo to bring to market world's lightest VR glasses

Dlodlo is in works to bring to market what the company claims to be the world's lightest portable immersive virtual reality (VR) glasses. Stylish, wireless and ultra-lightweight at just 120gm, Dlodlo VR glasses

look and fit like regular sunglasses. These offer full-HD resolution with 16:9 aspect ratio and a fast 120Hz refresh rate.

Dlodlo glasses support 2D/3D switch video, 4K video display and provide a 110° field-of-view (FOV). The glasses make users feel like warriors battling in a video game for an exciting VR experience. These do not require a PC or specific type of smartphone to use. These work on Android 4.4 OS with built-in Bluetooth and functions with any Bluetooth device, including gaming devices, smartphones, tablets and laptops. These adjust from 58mm to 70mm to help with vision problems, so there is no need to wear corrective glasses under the device.

Manipal Institute and Tata Power Solar unveil solar car

A team from Manipal Institute of Technology and Tata Power Solar has unveiled SERVe (solar electric road vehicle), the university's first prototype solar car. This four-wheeler runs entirely on solar energy, weighs 590kg and can reach up to 60kmph with a cruising speed of 30kmph.



Prototype of the solar car, SERVe, developed by teams from Manipal Institute of Technology and Tata Power Solar

Designed by the students of SolarMobil team, the car is custom-fitted with solar panels, which are designed by Tata Power Solar.

SERVE was designed keeping in mind the mobility and commercial viability, and the solar panels have been custom-made to fit the car's curved surface, enhancing the aerodynamics and performance of the vehicle. These panels weigh 35kg, which is less than half the weight of conventional panels, and provide up to 960W power. The car also houses a Direct Solar Drive, powered by solar panels, to maintain the cruising speed and is supplemented by extra power from its high-end energy storage system.